

He adds, “I can ask many questions to the world, like why did my father die when I was 19, and like why do some people get cancer and some don’t? Both fortunate and unfortunate things happen to people and spirituality helps one understand that there exists a law that governs all the actions we carry out.”

What Sharma likes about Buddhism is the way everyone attached to it follows the practice of faith of Buddhism in their everyday life. He explains that worrying about what would happen in one’s personal or professional life is a waste of time as it is all defined by the actions one takes. Calling it Karma, he notes, “The business of Deki Electronics is not just tied to my Karma but the Karma of 640 people associated with the company.”

“I think collective Karma is far stronger than an individual’s Karma. It is a far better way of protecting yourself from any risk than just being attached to your own Karma,” he says.

It was Sharma’s neighbour Ashok Lal who introduced him to the practice of Buddhism. In fact, his first meeting at ELCINA also contributed towards his development. When Sharma attended a meeting organised by ELCINA for the very first time he found the people there to be very cynical about how the affairs were handled by them.

“A lot of people at ELCINA only complained about how the government does not support them or has no idea how electronics businesses are run. The two meetings I attended at ELCINA were the same in terms of complaints and only complaints. I found these meetings to be leaving me with negative energy. I made up my mind to never go to such meetings again,” he explains.

But right after the second ELCINA meeting, Sharma went to the Sunday practice of Buddhism once again. The Sensei (guru in India) that day was talking about making a change in what one does not like as a part of the practices of Buddhism. This was when Sharma realised that ELCINA had a lot of scope of doing great for the Indian electronics industry.

“Young man, I see that you do not

Some less known facts about Vinod Sharma

Favourite food: Thai, Korean, and Italian

Favourite music: Instrumental

Favourite actor: Naseeruddin Shah

Favourite politician: Pretty happy with the economic and industrial policies introduced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi

Favourite books: Jonathan Livingston Seagull, Faith 24 × 7, Little Prince

Favourite sports: Football and Polo

Working hours/day: Started with 14, now 8 hours

Favourite past time: Riding horses and reading non-fiction books

Favourite cartoon: Asterix

like the way things are run here. Then why do you not do something about changing that,” Sharma recalls the words of his Sensei that day, the day that changed his life and made him start doing things to change whatever Sharma felt was not right.

“In that process I also found out that I was also wrong to some extent about judging ELCINA and its members so quickly. My work at ELCINA quickly got me a place in the executive committee and then I was also made the president of the organisation. In nutshell, the teachings of Buddhism have opened a whole world of opportunities for me and at the same time these have also given me a new way of seeing how things are and what things are,” he adds.

The other practice that Sharma feels Buddhism has empowered him with is the one that helps him cherish mistakes instead of hiding them. Taking tough calls is one of the everyday tasks that all leaders in the world have to accustom themselves to over and over again, and one of these tough decisions includes confronting their team members about mistakes they may have made.

“A lot of people, instead of cherishing mistakes, try to hide them. If not hide, people at least try to pass on the blame or have other team members share the blame for the same. I think the environment that cherishes mistakes is one that in the long run prevents mistakes from happening. If people who work with you learn to confront themselves about the mistakes they have made, they start becoming better human beings,” explains Sharma.

He adds, “But there are also days when bad parts of a bonsai plant have

to be cut to make sure that the rest of the bonsai is safe from rotting.” Bonsai is best explained as a miniaturised plant that adheres to the traditions of Japan. A bonsai is seen as a symbol of harmony, peace, an order of thoughts, balance, and all that is good in nature. These thoughts also reflect the teachings of Buddhism. A well grown and maintained bonsai plant reflects the discipline its creator follows.

“A very senior-level professional working at Deki Electronics once bought a very expensive machine as a part of our expansion plans. Now that machine was not at all a match for the task we had intended to fulfil, but the executive himself informed me and the whole management of Deki Electronics about the blunder he had done. We all laughed at it and that mistake has now been preserved as a teaching for all of us at Deki. This is what I will call the power of cherishing mistakes; you are able to create an environment that is unmatched, honest, and productive,” he says.

Apart from making Deki Electronics venture into new verticals like components used in electric vehicles and more, Sharma right now is busy making succession plan for Deki Electronics. Five to ten years down the line, he sees himself teaching somewhere and sharing knowledge. He often accompanies his son to polo practice and also enjoys playing football with him.

“Happiness is not being joyful and laughing at all times. Happiness, to me, is being able to deal with the setbacks that come in your way every day. It is being able to offer certainty to people around you even in uncertain times,” says Sharma. **EFY**